

SECURE FUNDER™

Verification Session Guide — What to Expect

Purpose

To confirm systems housing merchant data are configured to protect against unauthorized external sharing.

Enrollment & Timeline

Organizations are listed in the Secure Funder™ directory upon enrollment. All requirements do not need to be in place at the time of enrollment. Verification must be completed within **90 days** of enrollment.

Certification Guarantee

Certification is not guaranteed. Participants must meet all program requirements. Open or pending litigation involving misuse, unauthorized sharing, or mishandling of customer data will pause the certification process.

How It Works

Verification can be completed via live screen share or through the online self-guided portal. All submissions go through a final review before certification is granted.

Verification Requirements

The following sections describe each area reviewed during verification.

1. Email Security

Preventing unauthorized access to emails containing sensitive submissions.

Multi-Factor Authentication

MFA must be enabled.

Email Submission Handling

Submissions accepted via email — safeguards must be in place to prevent unauthorized access to attachments before or during human handling.

Example pathways:

- Submissions are routed directly to your CRM without human intervention
- Inbound [attachments are watermarked](#) before human handling
- Download controls or DLP policies prevent exfiltration of submission files

Submissions NOT accepted via email — provide documented guidelines or system settings confirming email is not an accepted intake method.

2. CRM / Portal Security

System-level controls to ensure access to merchant data is limited.

Multi-Factor Authentication

MFA must be enabled.

Role-Based Access

Personnel should only be able to access accounts and information required for their role. Sensitive fields (e.g., SSN, DOB) should be restricted based on business necessity.

Document Access Controls

If documents are accessible within your CRM and/or Portal, safeguards must limit the risk of unauthorized distribution.

Example pathways:

- Files are view-only and cannot be downloaded
- Documents are [watermarked](#) before entering the system or at time of download
- Download controls or DLP policies prevent exfiltration

User Verification

CRM users must be from your organization. No external entities — such as brokerages, software platforms, or other lending companies — should have access.

If related entities have access, the business rationale will be reviewed to determine whether it meets the intent of the requirement.

3. Document Storage

Secondary Storage

If documents are stored outside your main systems (e.g., Google Drive, Dropbox, shared folders), access controls, sharing restrictions, and encryption or protection measures must be in place.

4. Outsourcing

Third-Party Access

If BPO teams (on or off-shore) have access to merchant documents, safeguards must limit the risk of unauthorized distribution.

Example pathways:

- BPO personnel have view-only access and cannot download files
- Documents are [watermarked](#) before third-party access
- Download controls or DLP policies prevent exfiltration by BPO personnel

5. Personnel Controls

Organizational policies to protect data at the human layer.

Background Checks

Documentation confirming background checks are conducted.

Password Policy

A documented password policy or enforcement settings.

Workstation & Screen Security

A policy requiring screen lock and restricting personal cell phone use.

Off-Boarding Process

A process for immediately revoking system access when employees leave or change roles.

Remote Device Management

If employees access merchant data or systems remotely, the organization should have the ability to manage those devices (e.g., Intune, Jamf, Kandji).